disagreement with him. Veteran diplomat Katyayani Shankar Bajpai notes that his father Girija Shankar Bajpai, the first Secretary General of the Ministry of External Affairs, was one of the few advisers who were able to speak the truth to the powers that be. Nehru's successors simply followed in his footsteps because, in the words of B.M. Jain, political scientist and professor at Rajasthan University, 'they lacked either the intellectual stamina or political courage to tinker with the basic premises of the foreign policy as laid down by him'.[45]

G.P. Srivastava echoes Edwardes when he asserts that the claim that Nehru's foreign policy 'raised the moral prestige of India' and helped maintain world peace was illusory. Srivastava cited a letter to an editor written in 1951 by Sir Jagdish Prasad, former member of the Governor General's Executive Council. According to Prasad, India was left with no friends in the West because of 'self-praise', 'arrogant self-conceit' and the belief that India's foreign policy was 'superior to that of all other powers because it is claimed to be based on truth and non-violence'. He wrote: 'The great powers do not wish to be told by implication that in contrast to our foreign policy theirs is based on trickery and violence; that we are the only people in the world to handle international affairs on a moral basis, and that our superiority on this score is now universally recognized and receives worldwide homage.'[46]

Even J.B. Kripalani, Praja Socialist Party (PSP) leader and a Congress stalwart during the freedom struggle, admitted in an article in *Foreign Affairs* in 1959 that India's prestige built up under Nehru had not helped 'advance any vital interests of India or diminish tension on her borders'. Kripalani argued '…the Indian government thought that the whole business of diplomacy consisted in enunciating the principles of international policy. But international politics is not concerned merely with enunciation of abstract principles. It is very much concerned with international diplomacy, strategy and tactics.'[47] According to Kripalani, there was always 'a danger